# *Lufthansa CEO warns jet fuel costs will spike airfares*

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By Tommaso Lecca · Nov 3, 2026, 12:13 PM · View in your browser

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“We need these increases in ticket prices in order to compensate for higher fuel prices,” Spohr said, speaking at a press conference on the airline group’s quarterly results .

“Ticket prices will go up in the two digits, and we already see this trend,” he added, pointing to this summer’s fare increases.

European airlines have so far avoided much of the impact of high jet fuel costs thanks to fuel hedging contracts that protected airlines from some of the fuel-price increase.

But many of those contracts are due to expire next year , leaving airlines more exposed to higher fuel prices.

Lufthansa has hedged more than three-quarters of the group’s fuel consumption in the first half of 2027, but that falls to 60% in the second half of the year, Spohr said.

“This is less than in 2026, logically, but still I can say that we are in a relatively comfortable position,” he added.

Lufthansa said that “due to the unchanged geopolitical situation,” its expected fuel bill for 2026 is €9.3 billion compared with €7.2 billion last year.

Lufthansa’s warning comes after Ryanair CEO Michael O’Leary said last month that he expected European airfares to rise by up to 20% next year if jet fuel prices remain high, with the Irish airline likely to raise its own fares by up to 15%.

“I don’t always agree with him, but here I have to agree with him,” Spohr said of O’Leary’s remarks.

However, the Lufthansa chief said he had no concerns about the availability of jet fuel at European airports, saying he did not expect a “supply bottleneck” and adding that the decline in air traffic during this winter will help keep fuel supplies stable.

Lufthansa on Tuesday announced a 9% increase in year-on-year revenues in the third quarter to €12.2 billion. The company recorded an operating profit of €1.4 billion, up 6% from the same period last year.

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